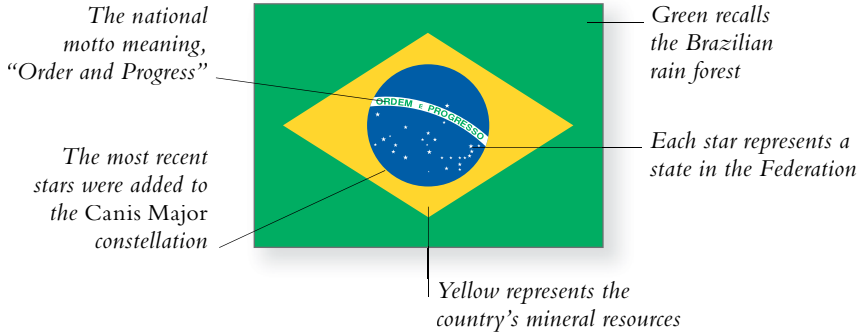


Brazil

Ratio: 7:10 **Adopted:** November 15, 1889 **Usage:** National and Civil



South America



Brazil belonged to Portugal until 1822 when it became an independent kingdom, and later an empire. It formed a federal republic in 1889.

The green field and yellow lozenge were part of the flag adopted in 1822 when independence was first achieved and the empire was declared. In 1889, the imperial arms were replaced by a view of the night sky as it appeared over Rio de Janeiro when the republic was formed. Each of the stars in the constellation represents a state of the Federation, including the Federal District. These have been altered from time to time, most recently in 1992 when the number of stars increased to 27.

THE CONSTELLATIONS

The constellations on the flag are represented in a realistic manner,

with stars of varying sizes, although the size of star does not reflect the importance of the state. In 1992, new stars were added to the constellation of *Canis Major* in the lower left section of the sky. The country's national motto, "*Ordem e Progresso*" meaning, "Order and Progress" appears on a band across the center of the night sky.

THE NATIONAL CAPITAL

In Brasília, the capital city since 1960, stands one of the world's tallest flagpoles, on which flies an enormous national flag.

Brazil also has flags for the President, the Ministry of Marine, and a naval Jack.